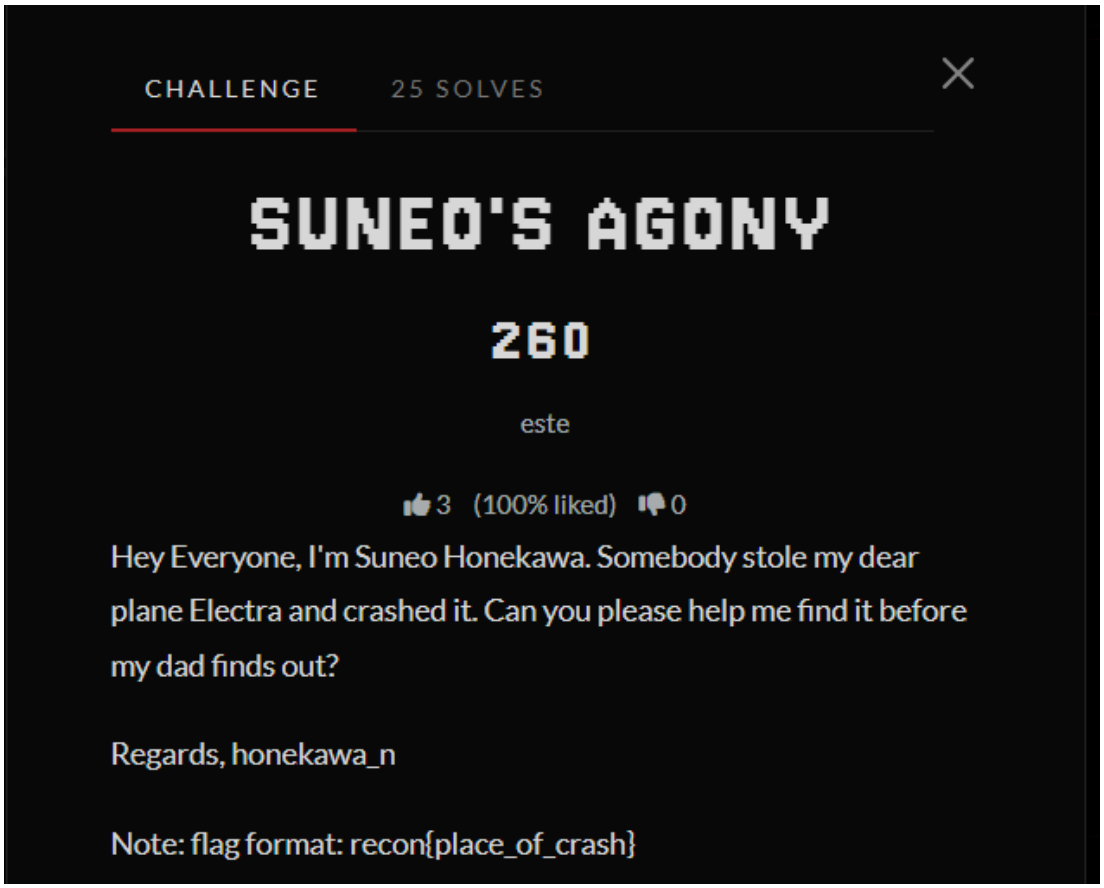
SUNEO’S AGONY

OSINT CTF WRITEUP

Following the clues from an Instagram account to an aircraft accident location.

CATEGORY • OSINT



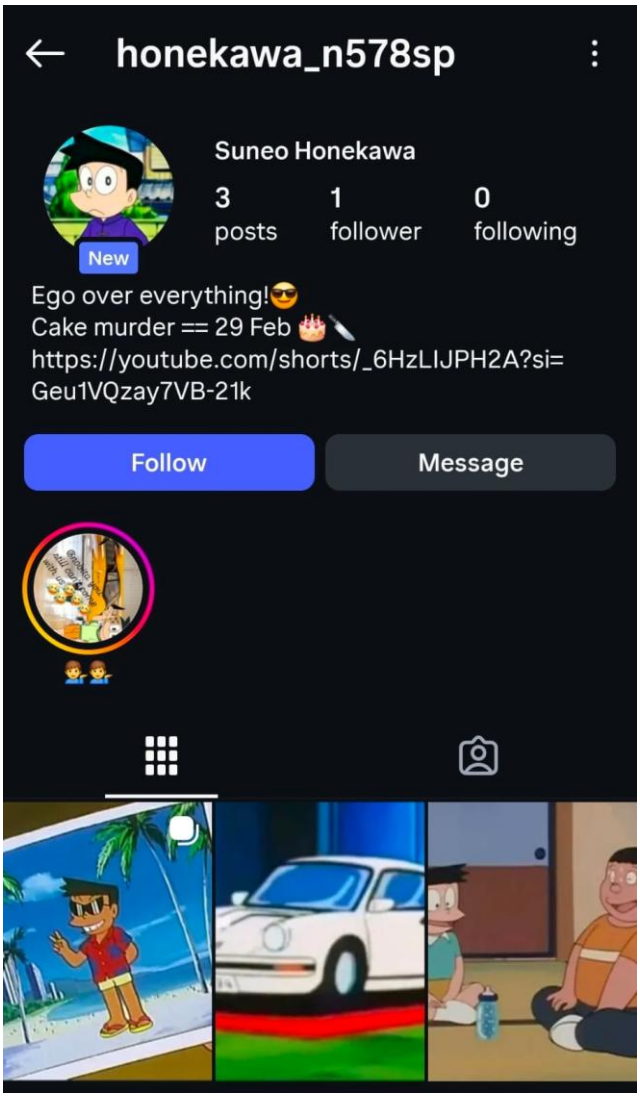
Challenge prompt: identify the location where the plane crashed.

Challenge overview

The challenge gives us a short story: Suneo Honekawa says someone stole his dear plane, Electra, and crashed it. The task is to find the crash location. The prompt also gives a useful starting point — the account name “honekawa_n” — and specifies the flag format as recon[place_of_crash].

Step 1 — Start with the account name

I started with the handle mentioned in the challenge, honekawa_n. Searching that lead brought me to an Instagram account using the username honekawa_n578sp. The account was the next clue to inspect rather than guessing the location from the challenge text alone.



The Instagram profile found from the handle clue.

Step 2 — Check the highlight

The profile had a highlight with an image of the aircraft. I checked the image closely because a registration or number printed on an aircraft can be used to search public aviation records.



The profile highlight that led to the aircraft image.

Step 3 — Read the aircraft number

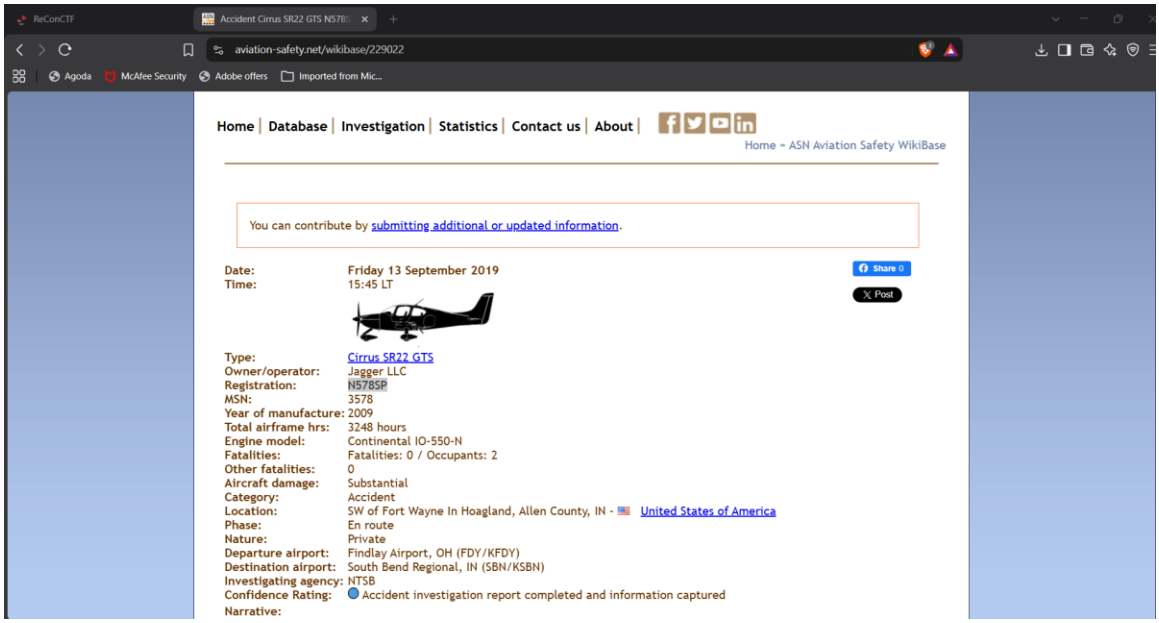
The aircraft image showed the registration N578SP. That gave me a specific identifier to search for in aircraft accident records.



Aircraft registration visible in the image: N578SP.

Step 4 — Find the accident report

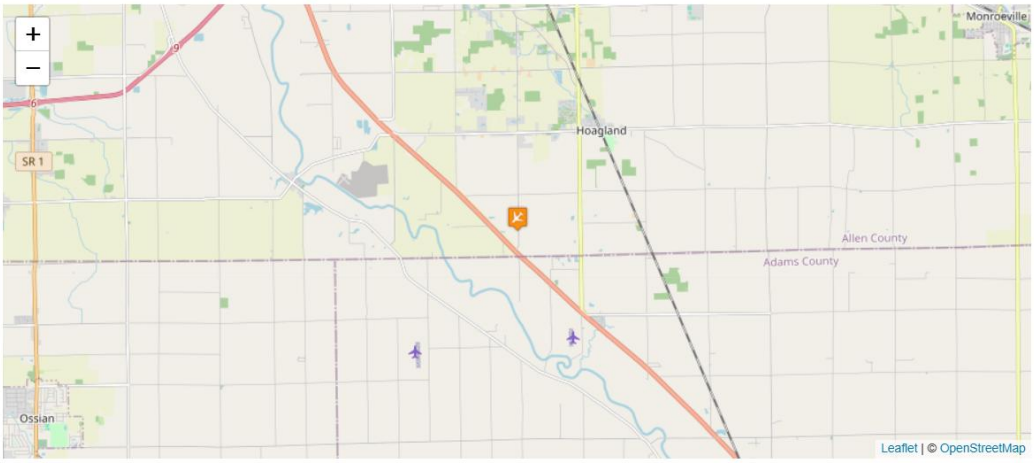
The challenge states that the plane crashed, so I searched for the aircraft registration along with aircraft crash or accident-report information. I found an accident report for the aircraft and checked its listed location.



Accident-record page used to identify the location.

Step 5 — Confirm the location

The report pointed to Hoagland as the accident location. The accompanying map was consistent with that location, so I used Hoagland as the place name for the flag.



Map showing the accident location.

Flag

`Recon{Hoagland}`

The solve came down to following the clues in order: the username led to the Instagram profile, the highlight revealed the aircraft registration, and the registration led to an accident report listing Hoagland as the crash location.